# MONKEY-TAILED SKINK

Corucia zebrata

**Think About This**

If you stayed with your family for years, what

**What can it see, hear, or feel?**

Its flickering tongue tastes the air, its eyes see in dim light, and it senses movement on branches.

**Where does it live — and why?**

It lives high in island forest trees, where its gripping tail holds on as it reaches for leaves.

**How does it send messages?**

It hisses as a warning, bites if ignored, and rubs scent on branches its family group shares.

**What does it do when something changes?**

When threatened, it grips tight with its tail, turns sideways, and hisses at the approaching danger.

**How does it learn?**

Young skinks stay in the family group for months, and adults protect them as they learn the trees.

**How does it have babies?**

A mother carries one big baby inside her body and gives birth live — unusual for a lizard.

**What are its limits?**

It needs special forest plants, so when trees are cut, both its food and its home disappear.

**What does this teach us?**

A lizard that lives in a family group teaches us that reptiles can cooperate too.